

February 15, 2026

To Whom It May Concern,

I am thrilled to write an enthusiastic reference letter for Rhea Dcunha. When Ms. Dcunha first asked me to write her a reference letter, I was beyond pleased to do so. Ms. Dcunha is an exceptionally strong candidate for your organization, given her rigorous quantitative and qualitative skills, exceptionally strong work ethic, critical thinking skills, extremely quick turn-arounds, and excellent writing skills, and her overall dedication towards addressing health disparities among marginalized populations.

Ms. Dcunha is a Master of Public Health student at Boston University, in Epidemiology and Biostatistics. Over the past two academic years, I have had the distinct pleasure of having Ms. Dcunha as part of my lab, Advocating, Liberating, and Supporting (ALAS) lab where she had engaged in various aspects of research on three separate studies (grant funded) and additional manuscripts preparation. In this role, research assistants are tasked with conducting literature reviews, writing methodology sections of manuscripts, running quantitative analyses, conducting qualitative research, screening participants for studies, and in abstract submission for national public health and social work conferences. These are often challenging tasks for graduate students, and many struggle with scientific writing and/or data analysis. Ms. Dcunha exceeded in all areas, most notably, by her extremely prompt turn-around time, which did not compromise her work. I have been repeatedly thoroughly impressed by the high quality of her work and the short time in which she accomplishes all tasks. I can confidently state that no other research assistant has been able to accomplish such rigorous work in a quick time frame. She often completes her assigned tasks before the deadline and has never missed a single deadline. This is extremely impressive given the various skill-sets needed to be employed (quantitative, qualitative, scientific writing) and across different projects. Ms. Dcunha's early completion of tasks has allowed me and the research team to begin the next step on a given project early, thanks to her work. Additionally, she has jumped in to take upon others' tasks when there are tight time frames.

Over the course of the past two academic years, Ms. Dcunha has managed the budget for three different grants, one of which is NIH funded. Ms. Dcunha has not only meticulously kept track of all three budgets simultaneously but knew the precise numbers in the budgets and was ready to discuss details at every single research meeting. This has been no simple task. Additionally, she has also worked and coordinated with various staff and Professors at Boston University, Yale University, and the University of Pennsylvania with regard to these grants. All her communication and interactions with the research team members and with colleagues at other universities and departments has always been executed in an extremely professional manner. I have no doubt that she will continue to do so in your organization. Ms. Dcunha has also been vital in making tables, charts and graphs to display the quantitative data she has conducted for my various studies. Our Society for Social Work and Research presentation utilized the graphs she designed.

Lastly, Ms. Dcunha's quantitative and qualitative skill sets have been an asset to the research team. She ran quantitative analyses on two of the studies, which has been used for the American Public Health Association (APHA) and SSWR national presentations. This data will be used in manuscripts that will be submitted for publication. It is rare to have a team member who is well skilled in both qualitative and quantitative methodology. Her exceptional execution of these tasks additionally demonstrated that she has a full understanding of the study and viewed her work on these studies as more than a task.

In closing, I am thrilled to support Ms. Dcunha for her application for this position. Ms. Dcunha stood out from other research assistants that I have mentored and worked with, for the aforementioned reasons. She is by far the best research assistant I have worked with, and I undoubtedly know that she will be an asset to your team. I support Ms. Dcunha for this position, without hesitation. Please do not hesitate to contact me if you require any additional information. My information is 508-506-1670 or djlopez@bu.edu.

Sincerely,

Daniel Jacobson López

Dr. Daniel Jacobson López, PhD, MSW, LCSW

Assistant Professor

Boston University, School of Social Work

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Certified Sexual Assault Counselor